

HUMAN AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

NOVEMBER 17, 2025

A meeting of the Human Affairs Committee was held Monday, November 17, 2025 at 7:00 p.m. in the Aldermanic Chamber and duly noticed in two places, including the City's website, in accordance with the requirements of RSA 91-A:2 II.

Let's start the meeting by taking a roll call attendance.

The roll call was taken with 4 members of the Human Affairs Committee present:

Alderman Thomas Lopez, Chairman, presided.

Members of the Committee present: Alderman Thomas Lopez, Chair
Alderman-at-Large Alicia Gregg
Alderman Tim Sennott, Clerk
Alderman Chris Thibodeau

Members of the Committee absent: Alderwoman-at-Large Shoshanna Kelly, Vice Chair

Also in Attendance: Heidi Peek-Kukulka, Health Officer (via Zoom)
Mike McGuinness, Deputy Health Officer
Bobbie Bagley, Director of Public Health and Community Services

ROLL CALL

PUBLIC COMMENT - None

DISCUSSIONS AND/OR PRESENTATIONS

- Rodent activity and prevention

Chairman Lopez to recognize Health Officer Heidi Peek-Kukulka.

COMMUNICATIONS - None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS - None

NEW BUSINESS – RESOLUTIONS – None

NEW BUSINESS – ORDINANCES - None

TABLED IN COMMITTEE - None

GENERAL DISCUSSION

PUBLIC COMMENT- None

REMARKS BY THE ALDERMEN

ADJOURNMENT

**MOTION BY ALDERMAN SENNOTT TO ADJOURN
MOTION CARRIED**

The meeting was declared adjourned at 8:26 p.m.

Alderman Tim Sennott
Committee Clerk



Rodents in Nashua

Mike McGuinness
Environmental Health Department
11/17/2025

Land Acknowledgement



- We are located on unceded and occupied land called **N'dakinna**, the traditional ancestral homeland of the **Abenaki, Pennacook, and Wabanaki Peoples** past and present.
- The word *Nashua* or *Niswa-ok* in the Abenaki language, means *place of two rivers*.
- Please pause as we acknowledge and honor these People who have been stewards of this land and water for hundreds of generations.

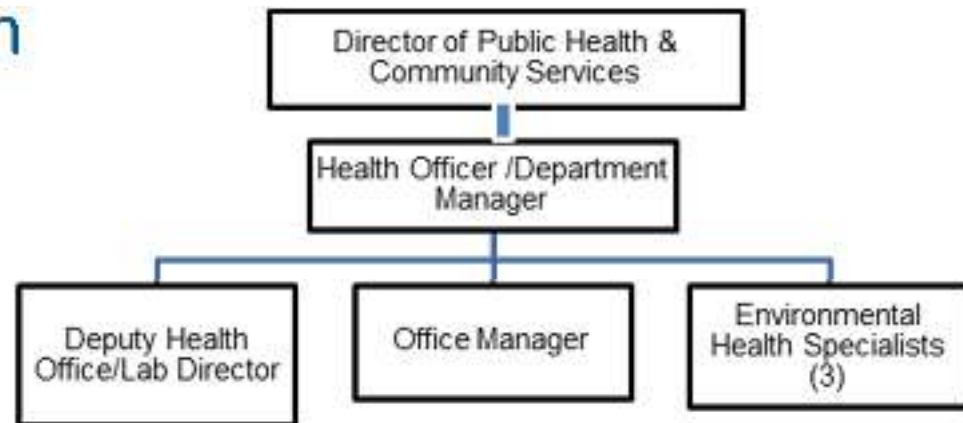
Mission Statement



- To protect the public's health by promoting best prevention practices through science, education, guidance and fostering public trust; and enforcement of laws and ordinances.

EH Staff

- Health Officer: Heidi Peek-Kukulka
- Deputy Health Officer: Mike McGuinness
- Office Manager & Quality Improvement & Compliance Specialist: Linda Alukonis
- EHS-II: April Torhan
- EHS-I: Tim Poitras
- EHS-I/II: Vacant



Services and Functions

- As the Chief Public Health Strategist for the City of Nashua, Environmental Health Department (EH).
 - protects and promotes the health of the public by defining, eliminating, controlling and managing environmental health hazards.
 - accomplished through the enforcement of laws and ordinances that protect the public from specific harmful environmental conditions.
 - Programs and services provided by EH include:
 - Food service inspections, trainings, complaints, site visits, sampling, plan reviews, change of ownership inspections, pre-licensing inspections, emergency responses, and food borne illness investigations
 - Housing inspections
 - Pool and spa inspections
 - Child care, foster home, and Dept. of Education inspections
 - Septic system plan approvals
 - Rabies investigations
 - Oversight of the Arboviral Surveillance Program.
 - Dog/cat bite reports
 - Technical Review
 - Asbestos & Demolition Permit Sign-offs
 - Licensing of Solid Waste Haulers
 - General Complaints
 - Disinterment
 - EH is committed to providing education to the general public, business owners, and license holders on a variety of environmental health subjects. The Health Officer, Deputy Health Officer, Office Manager and three (3) Environmental Health Specialists deliver these services in the City of Nashua, but also provide technical assistance to the state and surrounding health officers upon request. This staff is fully funded by the City of Nashua.

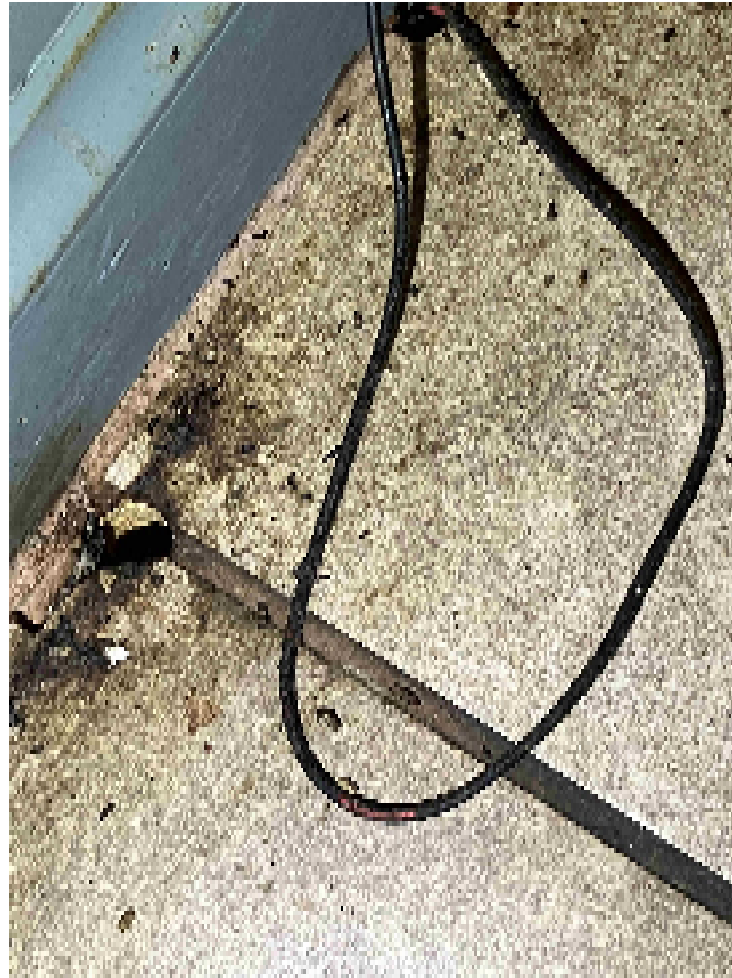
Rats & Mice



- Increasing numbers in Nashua
 - ▣ Increases in complaint calls in food service establishments, commercial establishments, residential settings
 - Variety of contributing factors causing rodents to be prevalent in areas where they have never been an issue before
 - Climate change
 - Covid-19
 - Garbage & waste
 - Increase in backyard livestock
 - Development & Construction



Foodservice Establishments



Commercial Facilities



Residential Settings

Prevention



- ❑ Deny food, water, and harborage
 - ❑ Food waste
 - ❑ Animal feed/waste
 - ❑ Leaky pipes
 - ❑ Clutter & debris
- ❑ Seal any holes/cracks/cervices
- ❑ Maintain a neat and orderly property
- ❑ Clean up rodent sign and monitor for new activity
- ❑ Work with a licensed pest professional to exterminate and exclude



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NashuaDPHCS



@NashuaPHealth



NashuaPublicHealth



Nashua Public Health



Questions?

Mike McGuinness

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(603)589-4534

THANK YOU



CITY OF NASHUA
Division of Public Health
& Community Services

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